

Evaluation Design Contract

PROJECT DISCOVERY ARTIFACT
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Complete before sourcing or pilot execution.

Use this artifact to expose assumptions, decision rights, coverage gaps, and quality risks while the design is still inexpensive to change.

1. DECISION AND OUTCOME CLAIM

- Decision this work must support
- Primary decision-maker and users
- Consequence of false positive / false negative
- Definition of useful evidence

2. TARGET BEHAVIOR

- Capabilities and prohibited behavior
- Observable indicators
- Context and task boundaries
- Known proxy risks

3. COVERAGE ARCHITECTURE

- Domains, languages, populations
- Difficulty and ambiguity strata
- High-consequence edge cases
- Exclusions and known unknowns

4. GROUND-TRUTH AUTHORITY

- Factual / expert / preference / policy / plural
- Source and provenance
- Authority by judgment type
- Appeal and escalation path

5. DATA SOURCING METHOD

- Created, collected, synthetic, transformed
- Expert qualification
- Security and confidentiality
- Sampling and representation risks

6. EVALUATION RUBRIC

- Criteria and adjacent score anchors
- Rationale requirement
- Examples and counterexamples
- Prohibited shortcuts

Calibration, acceptance, and decision

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7. CALIBRATION PROTOCOL • Qualification set and pass logic • Gold / anchor cases • Group review sequence • Calibration evidence retained	8. DISAGREEMENT AND ADJUDICATION • Expected vs material disagreement • Independent rationale review • Adjudicator authority • Rubric defect vs reviewer defect
9. QUALITY MEASUREMENT • Construct validity • Coverage and slice performance • Agreement, drift, rationale quality • Rework, cycle time, decision utility	10. PILOT DESIGN • Representative sample and strata • Instrumentation and traceability • Review cadence • Learning questions
11. ACCEPTANCE / STOP RULES • Evidence required to advance • Conditions to narrow scope • Conditions to redesign rubric/data • Conditions to hold or stop	12. OWNERSHIP AND CHANGE CONTROL • Decision owner • Rubric / dataset versioning • Change approval and communication • Post-pilot ownership

DESIGN DECISION

Advance Evidence is sufficient for pilot.	Narrow Reduce scope to valid coverage.	Redesign Repair construct, rubric, or source.	Hold Risk or ownership is unresolved.
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REQUIRED SIGNATURES / ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

Client decision owner · Research/product representative · Engineering representative · Braintrust program manager · Principal strategist · QA/contributor operations representative